

LJ CONNOLLY

EDUCATION

The University of Central Florida

PhD: Text and Technology (expected in 2029)

The University of South Florida

Master's of Arts: Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies (2025)

Thesis: "Breaking Binaries: Gender Non-Conforming Lesbians and the Undercurrent of Biopower on Dating Apps" Committee: Dr. David Rubin (chair)

The University of Tampa

Bachelor of Arts in Writing (2021)

The University of Oxford

Study Abroad Student: Concentrations in Women's Studies and Major Novels (Fall 2019)

RESEARCH

The University of Central Florida

Graduate Research Assistant (August 2025 to current)

The Center for Humanities and Digital Research

The University of South Florida

Graduate Student Researcher:

National Science Foundation: Award No. 2127228 (August 2023 to present)

Primary project: "Embodiment, Collective Memory, and Political Geographies: Ethical Praxis and Collective Reckoning with Racial Violence in the U.S. South"

Chair of sub-project: "The Atmospheres of White Memory: Unveiling the Invisible Geographies of Racial Violence in Polk County"

Conference Presentations

"Embodiment, Collective Memory, and Political Geographies: Ethical Praxis and Collective Reckoning with Racial Violence in the U.S. South." The American Anthropological Association, November 2024.

"Gender Expansive Embodiment in the Borderlands." The Mid-Atlantic Popular Culture Association, Summer Symposium, August 2024.

"Creative Fiction and Political Discourse in the Virtual Storytelling Space, Twine." The American Studies Department of Hacettepe University, Turkey: Digital Games as Cultural and Literary Narratives, May 2024. <https://asdturkey.hacettepe.edu.tr/en>

"Breaking Binaries: Nonbinary Lesbians and Navigating Narrative Identity Formation on Dating Apps." The University of South Florida's 13th Annual WGSS Research Colloquium, April 2024.

"'Weaving' and 'Mosaics' of Gender Binaries and Colonized Borders: A Case Study of Gloria Anzaldua's Borderlands/La Frontera: The New Mestiza." The University of South Florida's Transnational Feminisms Mini-Conference, April 2024.

“Anarcha Feminist Pedagogy in Virtual Learning Environments.” The University of Wisconsin-Madison’s Women’s & Gender Studies Consortium, April 2024.

CREATIVE WRITING PUBLICATIONS

Connolly, L. J. (2021, November). The witches dance. The Ekphrastic Review. Retrieved from <https://www.ekphrastic.net/the-ekphrastic-challenges/ekphrastic-writing-responses-the-witches-dance>

Connolly, L. J. (2019, July). ROAR. Bullets into Bells. Retrieved from <https://bulletsintobells.com/2019/07/23/roar/>

Connolly, L. J. (2022, April). The residue of womanhood. Bending Genres. Retrieved from <https://bendinggenres.com/issue-twenty-five/>

TEACHING

The University of Central Florida

Graduate Teaching Assistant (August 2025 to current)

Digital Imaging Fundamentals, Nicholson School of Communication and Media

The University of South Florida

Graduate Teaching Assistant (August 2023 to May 2025)

Intro to Women’s Studies, Department of Women’s, Gender, and Sexuality Studies

The University of Tampa

Professor’s Assistant for First-Year Seminar (August 2019 to May 2021)

The Center for Teaching and Learning

RELEVANT INDUSTRY WORK

Assessment Scorer (December 2024 to May 2025)

Pearson Education

Copy Editor, Proofreader, and Tutor (June 2021 - December 2024)

Pear Deck Tutor (previously TutorMe)

Digital Media and Content Writing Internship (May 2020 - August 2020)

That's So Tampa Examples of work.

Marketing and Copy Editing Internship (September 2018-September 2019)

Connolly and Callaghan Ltd. Examples of work.

SERVICE

ADMINISTRATIVE & DIGITAL PRODUCTION EXPERIENCE

The University of Central Florida

Podcast Producer, Cheddar Talks (June 2026–present)

Center for Humanities and Digital Research

Web Content and Digital Project Development (September 2025-July 2026)

GitHub Pages sites, instructional design, and presentation materials

Cuban Digital Art Research Guide (January 2026-July 2026)

UCF Libraries: artist directory research and content development for a curated library research guide

Cover Design, The Florida Review (January 2026-July 2026)

Cover development in Adobe InDesign for the literary journal

CONFERENCE PLANNING AND INVOLVEMENT

The University of South Florida

Application Reviewer, Conference on Democratic Violence in Latin America, March 2025.

Application Reviewer and Proposal Committee Member, National Women's Studies Association, November 2024.

Moderator, "Literature and Psychology" Panel, University of South Florida's 5th Annual Undergraduate Humanities Conference, January 2024.

Co-Moderator, "Safeguarding Voices: A Symposium on Academic Freedom and Diversity" The University of South Florida, February 2024

Moderator, "Thinking Asexuality: Interrogations Across Disciplines and Perspectives" Thinking Sex Conference, March 2024